ASCII Master Flowchart — Topic 17

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ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM — TOPIC 17: AKBAR'S RELIGIOUS VIEWS
1563 pilgrim tax remitted -> 1564 jizya abolished -> 1575 Ibadat Khana
-> after 1578 wider participation -> 1579 Mahzar -> 1581/82 closure
-> private inquiry + translations + sulh-i-kul + restricted discipleship
RULE: policy evolved; 1582 did not create a mass religion.

reform -> debate -> Mahzar -> sulh-i-kul -> discipleship
belief != policy != sovereignty != encounter != fellowship

IBADAT KHANA
Fatehpur Sikri / Niyazi cell + Anup Talao -> Thursday-night forum
-> first phase: ulama + Sufi shaikhs + learned men + companions
-> later phase: Hindu + Jain + Christian + Zoroastrian voices
-> closure of public forum, continuation of inquiry elsewhere

MAHZAR
qualified jurists disagree -> emperor selects existing opinion
-> public welfare + administrative order -> bounded imperial arbitration
LIMIT: not prophethood, papacy or unlimited sacred legislation.

SULH-I-KUL
justice + public welfare + non-sectarian governance
-> tax relief + service inclusion + plural patronage + translation policy
LIMIT: hierarchy, coercion and ruler-centred authority remained.

TAUHID-I-ILAHI / DIN-I-ILAHI
Absent: scripture + priesthood + congregation + mass mission
Present: initiation + shast + greetings + four degrees of devotion
Scale: very small elite circle; Birbal prominent Hindu name
Verdict: restricted spiritual-political fellowship, not mass religion.

SOURCE METHOD
Abu'l Fazl -> ideology and detail | limit: panegyrical court project
Badauni -> dissent and anxiety | limit: polemical hostility
Jesuits -> encounter and books | limit: conversion expectation
Orders / grants / material setting -> concrete tests | limit: uneven reach / uncertain identification

2025 GS-I direct route: early reforms -> Ibadat Khana -> Mahzar -> sulh-i-kul -> limited Tauhid-i-Ilahi -> r
2026 search outcome: no direct Topic-17-owned question verified locally.
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